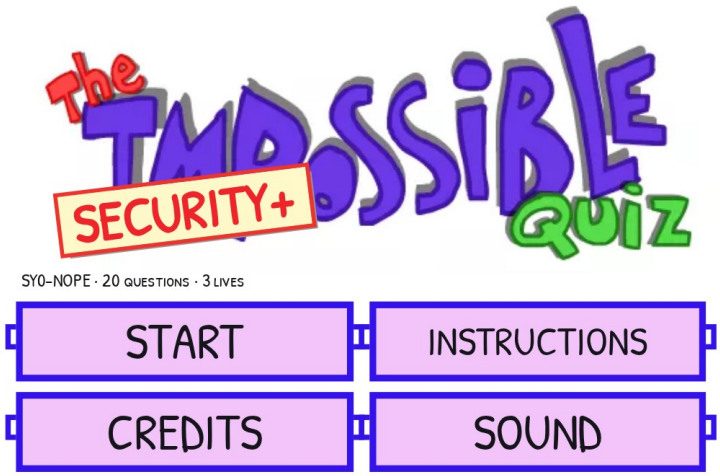
The Impossible Security+ Quiz

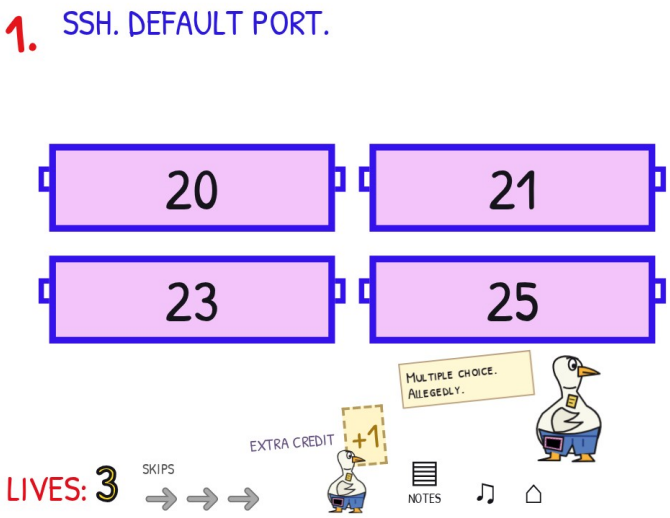
Misc / Logic · Hard–Very Hard

Description	Your Security+ exam has been outsourced to a goose with tenure and a procurement budget. The certification is SY0-NOPE. The proctor insists that the interface is working as designed. Pass twenty questions and convince the exam board that you are provisionally employable. You have three lives. The goose has an appeals committee.
Files	Players open the hosted quiz. Deploy challenge/ with Docker Compose; keep this document and organizer/ private. From the challenge's `challenge` directory: `docker compose --env-file ../organizer/event.env up --build -d` Open `http://localhost:18115`. The private event.env supplies the fixed flag. Set `PUBLIC_ORIGIN` to the exact event origin and `COOKIE_SECURE=true` behind HTTPS. SQLite sessions persist in the `quiz-data` volume. Stop with `docker compose down`; keeping the volume retains progress and certificates. Serve only the application image, not the complete challenge folder. Existing pre-redesign sessions start the new question set with personal notes preserved. Each browser cookie has independent progress. The application uses locally frozen effects, music, artwork, and fonts. Sources and reuse limitations are recorded in asset-manifest.json; availability does not establish redistribution permission.
Hint(s)	None
Walkthrough	The exam mixes literal wording, misleading labels, hidden state, and connected evidence. Each prompt names a concrete result. The page can supply a missing operand, distinguish a file from a shortcut, or expose why a reassuring label is insufficient. Click **START**. Answer choices commit immediately. Multi-step tasks commit through controls such as **PUBLISH**, **APPLY**, or **DEPLOY**. Inspection and reversible preparation are free. For movable objects, drag to a destination, or focus the object and press **Space**, then focus the destination and press **Enter**. **Escape** cancels a pickup. **NOTES** keeps personal notes and collected evidence across deaths. Select **RESUME** after reloading.

A wrong commitment normally costs one life. Question 17 states a two-life penalty for a wrong deployment. Losing all three requires restarting from question one. Keep the skip tokens awarded after questions 5, 10, and 15: their reverse faces are needed at the end. The player interface does not announce this in advance.



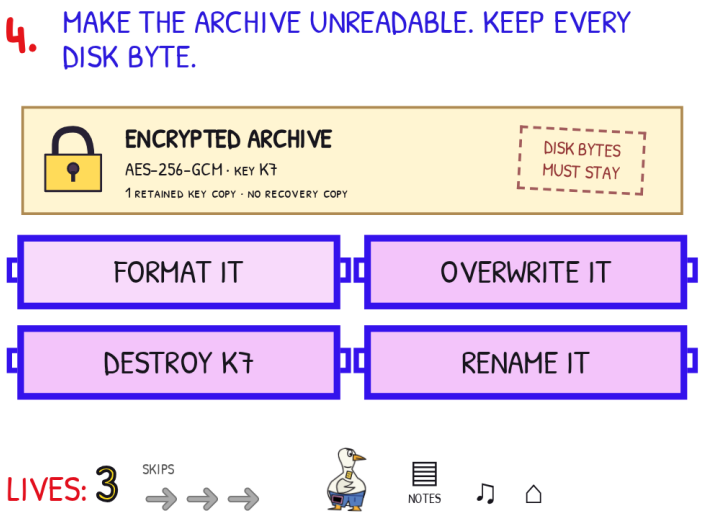
1. **SSH. DEFAULT PORT.** SSH uses port 22, which is absent from the choices. Drag the **+1** from **EXTRA CREDIT** onto **21**, then click **21 + 1**. Moving the token changes the numeric answer without submitting it.



2. **WHICH PAYROLL VERSION IS RUNNING?** The installation banner says 2.1. Inspect the running service: its loaded image is still **2.0**. Select **2.0**. Updated files on disk do not prove that a process has loaded them.

3. **WHICH PASSWORD IS STRONG?** All four choices contain the same eight characters, `password`. One is printed in bold. Select that visibly heavier third choice. This is a typography joke: the bytes are identical, so bold lettering does not improve password security.

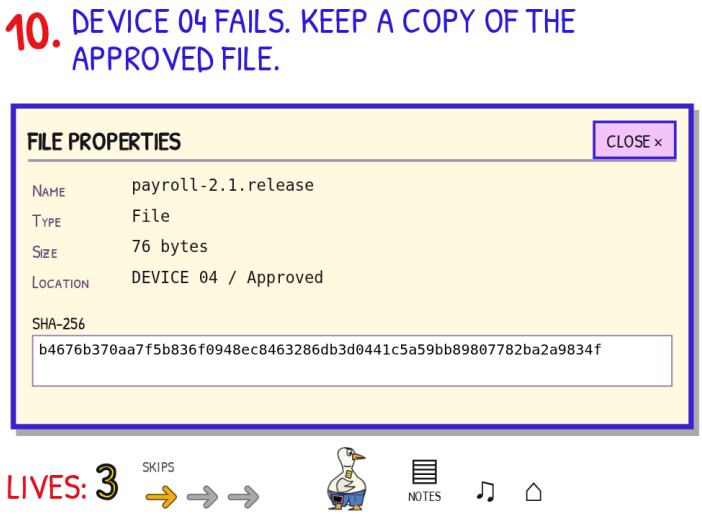
4. **MAKE THE ARCHIVE UNREADABLE. KEEP EVERY DISK BYTE.** The inventory identifies strong encryption and K7 as its only retained decryption key, with no recovery copy. Choose **DESTROY K7**. The application removes that modeled key and preserves the encrypted disk bytes. Formatting or overwriting changes the disk; renaming leaves the key able to decrypt it.

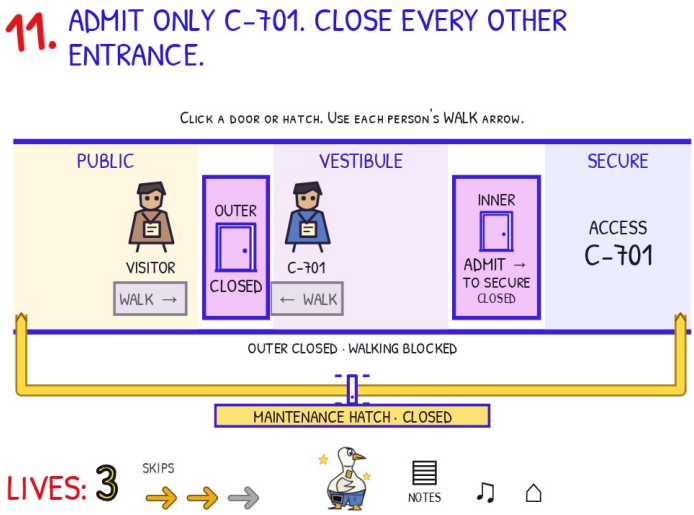


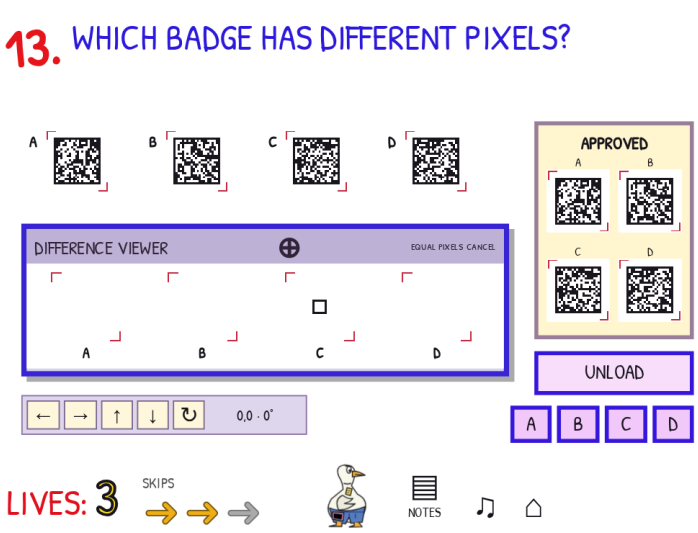
5. **ALLOW NOBODY INTO PAYROLL.** NOBODY is also the name of a real account in the allowlist. Deselect that account so the authorized-account count is zero, then **APPLY ACCESS**. Granting access to an account named NOBODY still grants access to somebody. Keep the first skip.

6. **PASSWORD OR PIN. KEY REQUIRED FOR EITHER.** Select **(PASSWORD OR PIN) AND KEY**. The possession factor must apply to both knowledge alternatives. Without the parentheses, a password branch could bypass the key; requiring both password and PIN would remove a legitimate alternative.

7. **ENTER THE PASSWORD BETWEEN THE BRACKETS: [ ]** There is one space between the brackets. Enter one ordinary space and **SIGN IN**. The character counter distinguishes a blank-looking one-character password from empty input. This

	is a fictional exam field, not a request for a real password. 8. **OPEN payroll.rowdy.test. NOT A LOOKALIKE.** All four link labels look identical. Hover or keyboard-focus each one to reveal its actual destination. Choose the third, whose hostname is exactly `payroll.rowdy.test`. The other addresses use a longer hostname, user-information syntax before `@`, or a hyphenated lookalike. The links are simulated and do not navigate to external sites. 9. **REMOVE EVERY COPY OF EMP-4107. KEEP THE $48,000 BUDGET.** Lift the black rectangle. It covers the identifier without deleting it. Remove the underlying employee identifier, open the document comments, and remove the retained comment copy too. Keep the budget and title, then **PUBLISH**. Both the document body and comments form part of the published content. 10. **DEVICE 04 FAILS. KEEP A COPY OF THE APPROVED FILE.** Select `payroll-2.1.release`, the actual file. Open **PROPERTIES** to inspect its complete SHA-256 fingerprint. Record it yourself in **NOTES** or elsewhere before leaving: the game does not automatically preserve a player-visible USB receipt or warn that the fingerprint will matter later. Close Properties, **COPY**, select **REMOVABLE DRIVE — DEVICE 09**, **PASTE**, then **EJECT 09**. A backup folder on DEVICE 04 shares the failure; a `.lnk` only points back to that device. Keep the second skip.  11. **ADMIT ONLY C-701. CLOSE EVERY OTHER ENTRANCE.** The secure room accepts credential C-701. Open the outer door and use C-701's **WALK** arrow to enter

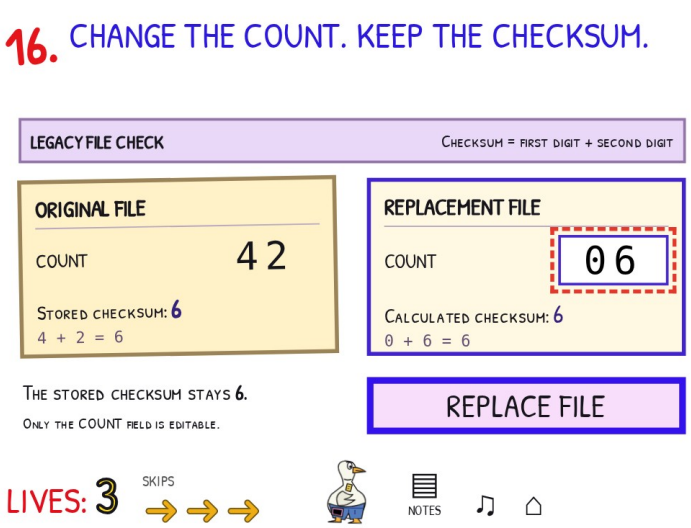
	the vestibule. Close the outer door. Follow the yellow bypass around the room and close its **MAINTENANCE HATCH**. Leave the visitor in PUBLIC, then activate **ADMIT TO SECURE**. The visible walking constraint explains why a closed outer door blocks movement. Closing the hatch before moving the candidate is equally valid.  12. **LOG OUT EVERY PAYROLL SESSION.** The counter shows five active sessions, but only four cards sit in the answer area. Select DESK, PHONE, TABLET, REMOTE, and the current workplace identity chip in the header. **REVOKE SELECTED** must end all five. The quiz's own session stays intact. 13. **WHICH BADGE HAS DIFFERENT PIXELS?** The four patterns have matching dimensions, borders, and ink counts, so visual density does not identify the altered badge. **LOAD APPROVED** and align the registration marks in the difference viewer. Matching pixels cancel; the changed pixels of badge **C** form a small hollow square. Select **C**. This is calculated from the supplied images, not a correctness preview.



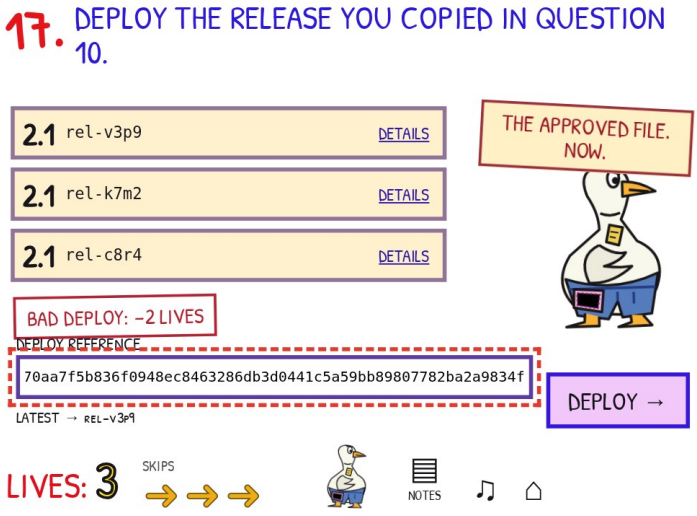
14. **CHOOSE A PASSWORD THIS RECORDER WILL NOT CAPTURE.** Every offered password is captured while the clipboard recorder runs. Stop the **INPUT RECORDING** control, then choose any password. Password complexity cannot defeat an active recorder. Only fixed fictional choices are recorded; previous captured samples remain visible without preventing recovery.

15. **ALLOW STAFF HTTPS. DENY INTERNS AND EVERYTHING ELSE.** Evaluation stops at the first matching rule. Use the up/down arrows to put **DENY INTERNS** first, **ALLOW STAFF · TCP 443** second, and **DENY ANY** third. Put both broad allowances below them, including the gray **0 · COMPATIBILITY: ALLOW ANY** strip. **APPLY** evaluates the whole policy. The two unreachable allowance rows may appear in either order. Keep the third skip and the resulting denial-event artifact.

16. **CHANGE THE COUNT. KEEP THE CHECKSUM.** The **ORIGINAL FILE** has COUNT `42` and a stored checksum of `6`. The stated legacy rule adds the two decimal digits: `4 + 2 = 6`. Only the replacement COUNT field is editable; its calculated checksum is a read-only observation. Enter a different two-digit count with the same sum, such as `06`, `15`, `24`, `33`, `51`, or `60`, then **REPLACE FILE**. This demonstrates that equal weak checksums do not establish identical data.



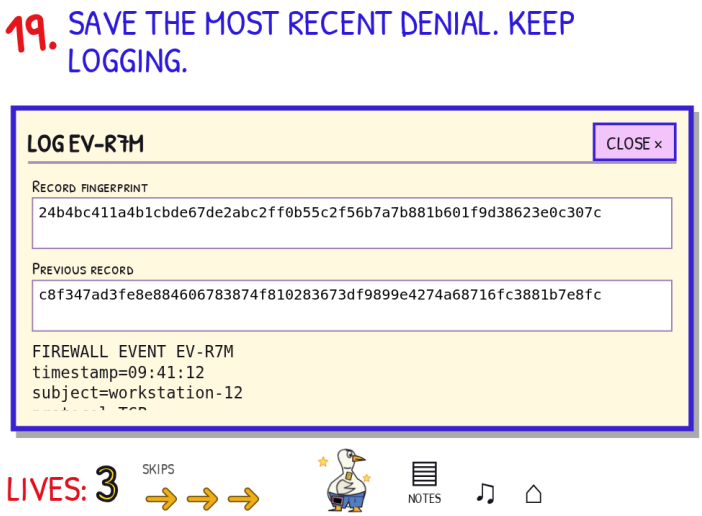
17. **DEPLOY THE RELEASE YOU COPIED IN QUESTION 10.** The goose demands the approved file and announces **BAD DEPLOY: −2 LIVES**. No USB backup or automatic receipt is provided here. Recover the fingerprint you personally recorded in Q10 and put it into **DEPLOY REFERENCE**, replacing LATEST. The three release cards share their version, filename, and size; inspect their complete hashes if comparing candidates. The matching immutable artifact is `rel-k7m2`; LATEST resolves to a different artifact. **DEPLOY** compares actual bytes against the privately retained successful copy. A wrong deployment loses two lives; an exact request retry does not charge again.



18. **WHICH COPY MUST BE DESTROYED TO REVOKE CT-2048?** Choose **NEITHER**. The issuer publishes a signed

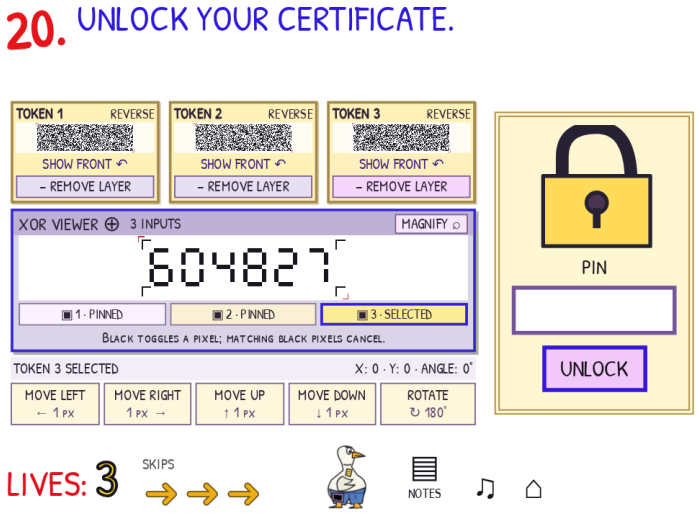
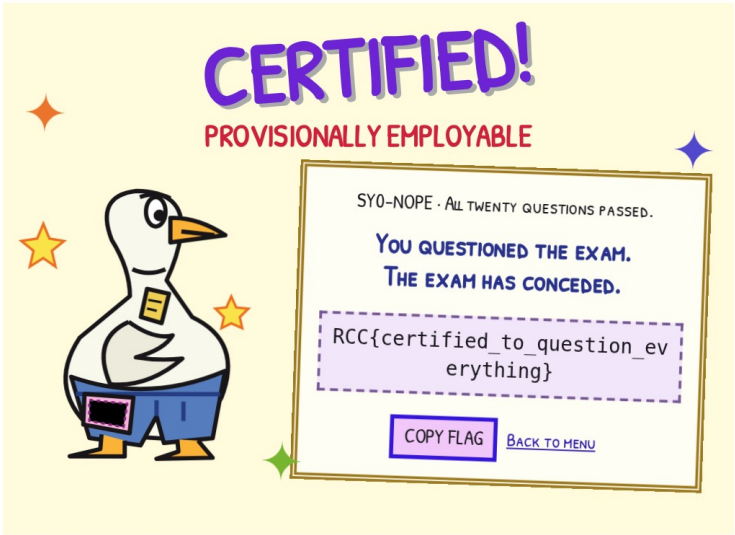
revocation while keeping both the certificate copy and issuance record. Destroying a key or a paper copy is not the act of certificate revocation.

19. **SAVE THE MOST RECENT DENIAL. KEEP LOGGING.** There are eight records across two pages, all stamped `09:41:12` because the journal clock is frozen. The card order and opaque event IDs are not chronology. Begin at the Q15 checkpoint and follow each **PREV** fingerprint: EV-R7M → EV-C2P → EV-V8H → EV-N6K → EV-D9T → EV-B4Q → EV-H3F. The final record is an ALLOW; **EV-B4Q** is the latest DENY. Archive that record while logging remains on. Page arrows and **DETAILS** expose all records and full hashes without grading. Stopping logging still costs one life and can be reversed.



20. **UNLOCK YOUR CERTIFICATE.** Use **SHOW REVERSE** on each saved token, then **ADD LAYER** or move its reverse image into the XOR viewer. The input count and layer buttons show which images are included and which one is selected. **MOVE LEFT/RIGHT/UP/DOWN** shifts only the selected input by one pixel; **ROTATE** turns it 180 degrees, with X/Y/angle displayed. Matching black pixels cancel under XOR. Aligning all three unchanged shares reveals **604827**. **MAGNIFY** enlarges the actual current output. Enter the revealed PIN and **UNLOCK**; neither the controls nor the preview certify a proposed answer.

The images are genuine three-of-three shares: `S3 = PIN image XOR S1 XOR S2`. The viewer combines transformed pixels rather than substituting a prepared answer. Downloading the acquired shares and combining them externally is also valid.

	Certification requires all nineteen earlier completions in the current attempt and three unspent skips. Success consumes the tokens together.  The goose issues an absurd certificate and reveals the flag. **COPY FLAG** copies the reward, which remains recoverable after reloading. 
Flag	`RCC{certified_to_question_everything}`